How Many Classifier-noun Constructions ?

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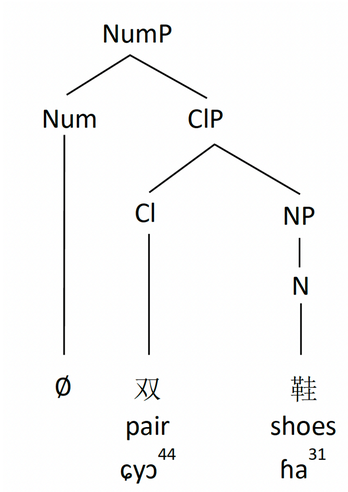
Please do not hesitate to contact me if you have any comments or questions! Thank you so much!

Introduction and Research Questions

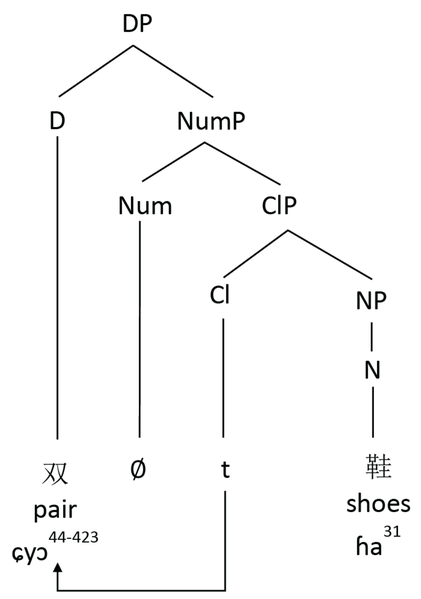
ClNCs (Classifier-noun Constructions) exhibit diverse characteristics across various dialects and contexts. It is difficult to have a unified classification criterion due to the differences between specific dialects.

Q1: How many ClNCs are there in Yongjia Wu?
This study figures out there are three classifier-noun constructions (type-A1, type-A2, and type-B respectively) in Yongjia Wu.
Q2: Why there exist such differences in one construction?
We can differ the differences according to their phonetic manifestations, referential meanings, syntactic distributions, syntactic structures, and pragmatic functions.

Tree Diagram of Type-A1 ClNCs



Tree Diagram of Type-A2/B ClNCs



Subcategories of ClNCs and Their Differences

	Type-A1	Type-A2	Type-B
Phonetic Manifestations of Classifiers in ClNCs	unchanged	unchanged	change into check tones
Referential Meanings	indefinite	definite (the)	definite (this/that)
Stand Alone	(+)	-	+
Distributions	①Being a subject in the matrix sentence of "……也未/也弗+（VP）"; ②Being an object within a verb-object structure or a preposition-object structure in a matrix sentence; ③The sentence involves the comparison of multiple objects (two and more).	①A type-A2 cannot appear alone in matrix sentence, but a modified type-A2 can appear alone in a matrix sentence; ②Type-A2 can be modified by personal pronouns, noun phrases, verb-object phrases, attributive adjectives with adverbs of degree, and relative clauses to form possessive constructions.	①Type-B can independently appear in matrix sentences; ②Being a definite subject/object/topic/ subject of an object clause; ③Participating in possessive constructions; ④Type-B can be modified by personal pronouns, noun phrases, verb-object phrases, attributive adjectives with adverbs of degree, and relative clauses to form possessive constructions.
Syntactic Structure	NumPs	DPs	DPs

Differences in Pragmatic Functions

	Situational Use		Discourse-deictic Use	Tracking Use/Anaphoric Use		Recognitional Use	Larger Situational Use
	Non-distinctive	Distinctive		Noun Constituents	Clauses		
Type-A1	/	/	/	/	/	/	/
Type-A2	+	-	+	+	+	+	+
Type-B	-	+	+	+	+	+	+

Others

Are ClNCs inherently restricted from standing alone in a matrix sentence?

When a ClNC is modified by a possessive, and it serves as the core element of the structure, the nominal element can be omitted without altering the meaning of the matrix sentence. This phenomenon applies to both type-A2 ClNCs and type-B ClNCs (type-A1 ClNCs have no possessives, so we can just neglect type-A1 ClNCs under these circumstances).

However, distinctions emerge among these ClNCs when it comes to single-classifier situations.

[A1] 双 ^{44}也未着起。

[A2] *双 ^{44}着起舒服厘。

[B] 双 $^{44\text{-}423}$着起舒服厘。

QR Code for Recording